Standard Operating Procedure (SOP)

Country Specific Requirements Belarus

Document Number: IQMS-70232
SSC-PTC-SOP-BY-005

Version: 5.0

Effective Date:	2025-06-30
QMS Area:	Quality
QMS Chapter:	4.9 Product Safety, Product Quality and Pharmacovigilance

Applicability

Bayer Level:	CH, PH

This document is electronically approved (signatures on the last page)

Distribution Sheet for Quality Regulations

Division/Business Unit	☒ PH ☒ CH
GBS Location	☐ Global Business Services Barcelona
	☐ Global Business Services Costa Rica/Brazil
	☐ Global Business Services Manila
	☐ Global Business Services Gdansk
	☐ Global Business Services Bangalore
	☒ Global Business Services Dalian
	☐ Global Business Services Germany
Region/ Country	☐ Global ☒ Specific Country: Belarus
Relevance for R&D QMS	☐ Affected ☐ Interface ☒ N/A

Version:	5.0
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Training Role(s):	GBS_DAL_PTC_CLUSTER 7
Relevant Process and Activities:	PTC

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1 Scope and Framework

1.1 Scope

Bayer Country Quality Units are accountable for a GMP compliant Product Technical Complaint Management within their respective countries. Within this responsibility they are supported by the respective Global Business Services in process steps like complaint initiation, forwarding for investigation to the RQU, and final verification including complaint sample management and reimbursement process.

This SOP defines clear guidance to the Global Business Services regarding all country specific requirements.

1.2 Framework

This SOP is based on principles and requirements outlined in SSC-PTC-SOP-001 “Manage Product Technical Complaint and Suspected Counterfeit Incidents in GBS”.

2 Abbreviations

AE	Adverse Event
CMO	Contract Manufacturer Organization
CQH	Country Quality Head
CQU	Country Quality Unit
GBS	Global Business Services
OTC products	Over-the-counter products
PTC	Product Technical Complaint
PV	Pharmacovigilance
RQU	Responsible Quality Unit
SSC	Shared Service Center

3 Purpose & Set-Up

3.1 Purpose

Country Specific Requirements for Belarus are described in this SOP, regarding e.g. Data Privacy, Sample Handling Process, Reimbursement Process, Contacts, escalation rules.

During the processing of all PTCs by Bayer owned Global Business Services all country specific requirements are considered and followed besides the general complaint handling described in the SSC-PTC-SOP-001 “Manage Product Technical Complaint and Suspected Counterfeit Incidents in GBS”.

3.2 General guidance

The employees of the Global Business Services are following the SOP during complaint processing in Complaint database on behalf of the Country Quality Units.

3.3 Roles and responsibilities

PTC GBS team	– manages PTCs and suspected falsification and counterfeit on behalf of the CQUs of the legal entity which introduces product into the market (e.g. Marketing Authorization Holder, Distribution license holder) – Enters PTCs, suspected falsification and counterfeit i and Usability Issues according to defined timelines, into the global complaint database in English language – forwards all cases that are not PTCs back to the CQU or applicable function for further processing – performs the initial intake of complaints after receipt and considering the information provided by the PV in case of an AE and/or a medical device (incl. Medical Device constituent of combination product) is involved – informs the respective PV about all PTCs with a potential associated AE or LODE or potentially reportable medical device complaints, including the unique complaint database number and all relevant follow-up information (e.g. Batch number) – informs the CQU about PTCs where local authorities are involved, about all potential falsification and counterfeits and any other cases described in the Country Specific SOPs – checks completeness and accuracy of information (including the photo or video, if available from the complainant) before forwarding the cases to the RQU – Initiates first contacts with the complainant within first 5 days of receipt of the complaint information to obtain follow-up information asks CQU for any support contacting the complainant if not possible/allowed by GBS (e.g. data privacy, non-hosted language) – ensures translation of non-hosted languages – forwards all cases to the respective RQU for further investigation and final assessment – checks if a complaint sample is available and starts the process to retrieve the sample, documenting these efforts including the number of attempts requesting sample in detail in complaint database – reviews the case for plausibility and closes the assessed complaint in complaint database – support the process for reimbursement management – documents the response in the global complaint database or other cross-referenced system in cooperation with the CQU/Quality contact person, if applicable – notifies the legal manufacturer of a device and where necessary, the manufacturer's authorized representative and the importer, if applicable.in case of any discussion or doubts contacts the CQH as the first line support
Country Quality Head (CQH) / Country Quality Unit (CQU)	– ensures the appropriate handling of PTCs, and suspected falsified and counterfeit incidents, reported in the respective country including the timely execution of the related activities, particularly for the entry of the cases into complaint database, forwarding them and for responding to the complainant

- responds to the complainant, for PTC+AEs in liaison with the PVCH and documents the response in the global complaint database or other cross-referenced system in corporation with the Global Business Services
- fulfills all obligations, e.g. PTC related reporting requirements defined by legislations or regulations
- oversees and monitors the whole PTC process for products on market of their legal entity in case of delegation to GBS by controlling appropriate Key Performance Indicators according to GSOP 1372 “Perform Country Quality Management Review”.

4 Specific requirements regarding PTC handling

4.1 Country Specific Requirements listed by different topics

Description	Assigned Roles & Document Reference

4.1.1 General Information

In Belarus the company operates under legal entity Bayer WR LLC, which is type B organization provides service for Bayer. The main office is in Minsk.

Bayer products are distributed by authorized distributors, which have agreements with Bayer AG Germany & Bayer Consumer Care AG (for PH products) and Bayer JSC Russia (for CH products).

4.1.2 Contact list

Quality responsibilities for Belarus are under Quality Department in Russia:

CQH RU – Olga Anokhina: *olga.anokhina@bayer.com*

CQH RU deputy – Evgeniya Shatalova: *evgeniya.shatalova@bayer.com*

Quality contact person for Complaint handling in Belarus is Olga Krutalevich *olga.krutalevich@bayer.com* (Natallia Salonskaya *natallia.salonskaya@bayer.com* deputizes Olga Krutalevich in case of absence).

Group email address: *ptc.belarus@bayer.com*

Both CQH RU and Quality contact person in Belarus should be approached in case of escalation.

Remark:
Current name and e-mail address of CQH and CQH deputy are found on the QINT SharePoint: *Country Quality List*

4.1.3 Escalation Rules

GBS

The CQH, the CQH deputy and Quality Contact Person should be notified via e-mail (also via generic CQU address if applicable) about any complaint case referring to at least one of the following situations:

- All cases with potential risk classification High or Medium*
- Suspected Counterfeit Cases
- Any cases involving Health Authorities
- Confirmed cases with final risk classification High or Medium

*potentially life-threatening or could cause a serious risk to health

Description	Assigned Roles & Document Reference

GBS to ensure escalate immediately to divisional Gatekeeper if the case is potentially life-threatening or could cause a serious risk to health. GBS to follow the instructions from divisional QA.

Remark:
Current name and e-mail address of the CQH and the CQH deputy are found on the QINT SharePoint: *Country Quality List*

4.1.4 Pharmacovigilance cases

GBS
CQU

If a complaint case is related to any type of Adverse Event, the Pharmacovigilance department must be informed via the following e-mail address within 24 hours from the moment of awareness.

Pharmacovigilance.Belarus@bayer.com

4.1.5 Product Samples

GBS

Due to that fact that Bayer WR LLC is legal entity type B and not authorized to conduct business operations with goods, samples sending is not managed by local organization.

In case when a sample is requested for investigation by RQU GBS informs the Quality contact person that the sample must be retrieved.

Quality contact person having the consumer's contacts requests the sample and documents attempts of a sample requesting. Quality contact person provides GBS with a result of sample obtaining, number/dates of performed attempts, in case of sample absence provides the reason. Based on provided information GBS notes results of obtaining in the Complaint Database.

In exceptional cases the complaint sample could be sent by the authorized distributor if the following requirements are met:

- Sample is declared to be available by the complainant.
- Distributor confirms that sample is received * and can be sent.

If all requirements are met, then Quality contact person asks the distributor via e-mail for sending a sample. After sending, the distributor notifies GBS about completion via e-mail. GBS includes this information in the Complaint Database.

Remark: * Regarding BY legislation a sample from an individual can be returned only via reverse supply chain. In certain cases, Quality contact person supports consumers in a product returning, if needed.

4.1.6 Statement letter

GBS

Acknowledgement Letter when a complaint comes in:

Due to data privacy requirements no acknowledgement letter is sent out by GBS. In certain case, e.g. when there is missing data in the initial complaint, the acknowledgement letter is prepared and sent by Quality contact person according to template in Annex 2.

Response Letter after closing:

Description	Assigned Roles & Document Reference

Regardless of whether a response was requested by the complainant, GBS notifies the Quality contact person about case closure via e-mail for further processing. The notification contains the Complaint Database number and Formatted output.

Due to data privacy requirements a response to the complainant is sent out by the Quality contact person or in some cases by CQH/CQU Russia.

In certain cases, Quality contact person requests Standard response to GBS. GBS prepares the Standard response according to templates in Annex 3 depends on the final RQU assessment (confirmed / unconfirmed quality defect / unconfirmed quality defect – but plausible) and sends via e-mail for further processing.

4.1.7 RQU Contact list

GBS

For CH products registration status in the respective country as well as Manufacturing Site are available via SYNAPS: go/synaps.

List with the respective RQU contact names are provided by the Divisional Quality Assurance function and available on the SharePoint:

PH: *PH RQU responsible list_HJ.xlsx*

CH: *IQMS_MASTER LIST COMPLAINT RESPONSIBILITIES.xlsx*

4.1.8 List of Local Opportunities Products

Local Opportunities Product is provided below.

Consumer Health Product:

Product name	Theraflex® Chondrocream Forte
Manufacturing site	AO “Nizhpharm”, Nizhny Novgorod, Russia (Complaint Database name “Joint Stock Company **Nizhny** Novgorod Chem. And Pharm. Plant (**Nizhny** Novgorod)”)
Contract manufacturer	Yes
Lead investigation unit	CO Russia (RU01) (In Complaint Database)

Product name	Theraflex® Plus
Manufacturing site	VTF Limited Liability Company, Russia (Complaint Database name “VTF Ltd. (Volginskiy)”
Contract manufacturer	Yes
Lead investigation unit	CO Russia (RU01) (In Complaint Database)

Product name	Theraflex® Ultra

Description	Assigned Roles & Document Reference

Manufacturing site	VTF Limited Liability Company, Russia (Complaint Database name “VTF Ltd. (Volginskiy)”
Contract manufacturer	Yes
Lead investigation unit	CO Russia (RU01) (In Complaint Database)

Product name	RelieBalance
Manufacturing site	VTF Limited Liability Company, Russia (Complaint Database name “VTF Ltd. (Volginskiy)”
Contract manufacturer	Yes
Lead investigation unit	CO Russia (RU01) (In Complaint Database)

4.1.9 Data Privacy Requirements

Data privacy requirements in Belarus are applicable for all information about individuals (name, address, phone number, e-mail), i.e., it is not allowed to transfer them to GBS.

Based on the foregoing complaints are managed only after anonymization.

Anonymization is performed for each incoming complaint from individuals by Quality contact person.

In case GBS receives complaint query first this email should not be processed without anonymization, therefore GBS forwards it to Quality contact person without undue delays.

4.1.10 Gathering additional information (including obtaining translation)

GBS
CQU

In case when the Quality contact person receives a complaint firstly by a phone, then Product Complaint Form (see Annex 1) is used to document received information. The Quality contact person sends this form to the GBS via e-mail as soon as possible, because timeline starts when phone complaint is received by Quality contact person.

All complaints are managed in Russian. Due to the fact Russian is a hosted language in GBS Gdansk, complaint e-mails in Russian are managed in GBS without using translation service.

Belarus has on average less than 100 complaints per year. Therefore, country is classified as micro language and, in case PTC officer with Russian is not available, GBS informs CQH/CQU Russia and Quality contact person about the absence of that person and asks to provide complaints already in English. This is the responsibility of Quality contact person to translate complaints to English before forwarding to GBS.

If a situation occurs that complainant sends an e-mail to GBS on an unfamiliar language the complaint must be translated by contacting Bayer Service Translation Office.

In case complaint is received via email the Quality contact person forwards an anonymized initial query and existing data related to complaint (pictures, video, etc.) to GBS without undue delays.

Description	Assigned Roles & Document Reference
The awareness date for Complaint starts when CQH/CQU Russia or Quality contact person receives a complainant query.	
4.1.11 Reimbursement and Replacement Whether a reimbursement for a product is granted, depends on final RQU assessment. In case of complaints raised from individuals/physicians reimbursement for the product is possible only for confirmed PTC through the reverse supply chain. The reimbursement process for the complaints raised by distributors is regulated in QAA. GBS is not involved in reimbursement handling process.	GBS
4.1.12 Mandatory Spot Checks for Translations For all countries where the complaints are sent out for translation to the BS translation office once a year mandatory spot checks must be performed. 5% of all complaint numbers per year should by checked by native speaker (based on random selection), e.g. CQU. Important is to check the “original income text” with “translated text” provided by BS translation office. The GBS is the owner of the process and start this action. The GBS leads the process, picks the cases and provides report to the CQU. The CQU checks the translation and indicates the deviations. Acceptance Criteria: • No Major translation deviations • Total number of Minor translation deviations is less than 5%. Deviations in the translation can be described as Minor or Major. • Minor translation deviations are deviations where a single word or short section of a sentence has been insufficiently translated, but the essence or meaning of the original message is still captured. • Major translation deviations are deviations where a single word or short section has been incorrectly translated (for example by the introduction of a new word or exclusion of a word from the original complaint in the translated version) which results in an incorrect essence or meaning in the translation of the original message. In case of a major translation deviation and exceeding the 5% minor cases, the GBS will be informed promptly to open a deviation in Complaint Database and to ensure appropriate CAPAs. In addition, the translation office needs to be informed.	GBS
4.1.13 Exceptions and special cases n.a.	
4.1.14 Others n.a.	

5 Internal References

- SSC-PTC-SOP-001 “Manage Product Technical Complaints and Suspected Counterfeit Incidents in GBS”

6 External References

- Not Applicable

History of changes

Version	Significant changes with respect to previous version	Effective date
1.0	not applicable	2020-05-27
2.0	Technical change of templates text was conducted (Annex 1).	2020-09-22
3.0	# Document is updated according to SSC-PTC-BP-002 “Country specific SOP template”: Chapter 3.3. GBS responsibilities updated Chapter 4.1.6 Escalation rules updated New chapter 4.1.12 Mandatory Spot Checks for Translation Annex 1 (Product Complaint Form) added # Format of “Applicability Sheet” was updated and renamed to “Distribution Sheet” # Change of document numbering in header from SSC-SOP-BY-005 to SSC-PTC-SOP-BY-005 # Chapter 3.3 Contacting local CMO was deleted from this Country Specific SOP # Due to organization change Quality responsibility for Belarus is under CQH RU (chapters 4.1.2, 4.1.5, 4.1.6 and 4.1.10 are updated accordantly). # Chapter 4.1.5 Product Samples is updated. # Chapter 4.1.6 Statement letter is updated # Chapter 4.1.9 Data privacy requirements is updated # Chapter 4.1.10 Gathering additional information (including obtaining translation) is updated # Chapter 4.1.11 Reimbursement and Replacement is updated # Chapter 4.1.12 Other – requirement of shared timelines is deleted as not applicable. # Annex 2 Standard response is added.	2022-11-01
4.0	# Chapter 1.2, 3.2, 5 Document name updated. # Chapter 3.3 GBS responsibilities updated # Chapter 4.1.2 Group email address added # Chapter 4.1.3 Escalation rules updated # Chapter 4.1.4 Wording adjusted # Chapter 4.1.7 Information updated # Chapter 4.1.8 List of local opportunity products updated # Chapter 4.1.10 CQU RU excluded from the process of information gathering, only Quality Contact Person is involved. # Chapter 4.1.11 Wording updated. # Annex 1 Updated PTC form from CIS-SUP-QA-021.1	2024-01-17
5.0	# Update Distribution Sheet # Update through all the document reflecting Global SOP-115 version 14.0 updates. # Replace “Dev@Com” with “Complaint Database” # Replace “Risk Category” to “Risk classification” # Replace session 3 roles and responsibility to align with GSOP 115, session 4.0, PTC GBS Team, Country Quality Head (CQH) / Country Quality Unit (CQU) # Updated CQH/CQU email address list in session 4.1.2 # Updated session 4.1.3	See Cover Page

	# Updated session 4.1.5, Replace “Dev@Com” with “Complaint Database” and other Dev@com relevant words # Updated session 4.1.7 new SharePoint link # Updated session 4.1.8 Replace “Dev@Com” with “Complaint Database” and other Dev@com relevant words	

7 Annexes

Annex 1

Product Complaint Form

PTC Notification Template / Форма PTC уведомления

Complaint occurred (date) / Жалоба создана(дата)…… ……
Complaint received (date) / Жалоба получена (дата)……..

Product information /Информация по подозреваемой Продукции:	
Product name / Наименование Продукции	
Batch / lot number / Номер серии	
Dosage form *(cream, tablet, etc.) / Форма выпуска (крем, таблетки, и тд)*	
Package type/size / Размер фасовки	
Number of packages / Количество подозреваемых упаковок	
Sample available? / Образец по жалобе доступен?*	Yes/No – Да/Нет
* If sample is available, retain for further potential shipment / Если образец доступен, сохраните его для дальнейшей возможной отправки	

Complaint information /Информация по Рекламации:	
Complaint description (/ Описание жалобы (	
Adverse event reported? / Сообщение по фармакобезопасности ?	Yes/No
Does the complainant expect a response from Bayer? ** / Ожидает ли заявитель ответа от Байер? **	

**The Complainant provides contact information to Bayer for the purpose of providing the answer to the submitted complaint / Заявитель предоставляет контактные данные «Байер» с целью предоставления ответа на поданную жалобу.

Complainants' contact information / Контактная информация Заявителя attention: due to special Data Privacy regulations Private data should be depersonalized (or replaced by the complainant local number, if applicable for cluster country) внимание: в связи со строгим законодательством по обработке Персональных данных, Персональные данные Заявителя должны быть деперсонализированы (или заменены локальным номером Заявителя, если применимо для страны кластера)	
Depersonalized name and surname (or local number) / Деперсонализированные ФИО (или локальный номер Заявителя)	
E-mail address / Электронный адрес	NA
Telephone / Номер телефона	NA
Home address / Домашний адрес	NA

Sender Contact details (if other than Complainant, e.g. a pharmacy) / Отправитель (в случае, если Заявитель не физическое лицо)	
Senders' Name (Legal entity) / Юридическое название отправителя	
Address /Адрес	
E-Mail address /Электронный адрес	
Telephone number /Номер телефона	

Additional information/ Дополнительная информация
_____ _____ _____ _____

Filled out by / *Заполнено*:	_____ Name, position / *ФИО, должность*	Date, signature / *Дата, подпись*

Annex 2



Acknowledgement_ letter.docx

Annex 3



Standard_response. docx

Task: Content Approval Verdict: Approve changes & release Approval to be made Effective	Zaneta Gorska-Bilas, (ZANETA.GORSKA-BILAS@BAYER.COM) Approver - Content 11-Jun-2025 06:19:26 GMT+0000

Task: Final Approval Verdict: Approve changes & release Final Approval to be made Effective	Jinghua Yin, (jinghua.yin@bayer.com) Approver 11-Jun-2025 09:31:36 GMT+0000